STRATEGIC IMPERATIVES

Team Action Plan Guide

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Team Action Plan

How to Use This Guide

A working guide to identify actions, clarify ownership, define success measures and build follow-up into the team's daily work.

PURPOSE Turn the team conversation into a small number of practical, visible commitments that connect Strategic Imperatives to priorities, decisions, behaviors and outcomes.

The action-planning standard

- **Relevant:** directly connected to a Strategic Imperative and the team's work.
- **Visible:** observable in day-to-day choices, routines and interactions.
- **Owned:** supported by one accountable owner and the right contributors.
- **Measurable:** accompanied by clear evidence of progress or impact.
- **Reinforced:** reviewed in an existing team rhythm until the action becomes embedded.

KEEP THE PLAN FOCUSED Select one to three meaningful actions. A short plan with clear ownership and follow-through is stronger than a long list with limited accountability.

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1. Start with the Strategic Connection

Begin by identifying the Strategic Imperative and the specific team opportunity surfaced through the conversation. The goal is to define why action matters before deciding what to do.

Planning element	Team response
Strategic Imperative	Demand Excellence in All We Do, Partner with Physicians, Be the Best Place to Work, or Drive Growth and Innovation
Team connection	Where does this imperative show up in our current priorities, decisions, behaviors or outcomes?
Opportunity or gap	What needs to improve, change or become more consistent?
Why this matters	Who will experience the difference, and why is the opportunity important now?
Starting evidence	What examples, observations, feedback or measures describe the current state?

Questions to help the team focus

- "What part of the team's daily work is most affected?"
- "What would become easier, stronger or more consistent if the team acted?"
- "Which part of the opportunity is within the team's influence?"
- "What should remain out of scope so the action stays manageable?"

LEADER SYNTHESIS "The opportunity we are addressing is _____. It connects to _____ because _____."

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2. Define an Action That Will Be Visible

Write the action as an observable practice, decision, routine or improvement. Avoid broad intentions such as "communicate better" or "improve teamwork" unless the plan specifies what people will actually do.

Use this action statement

ACTION STATEMENT "We will [specific action] by [target point or cadence] so that [intended result]."

Test the action

☐ Does the action begin with a clear verb?

☐ Can the team explain exactly what will happen?

☐ Will team members or partners be able to observe the difference?

☐ Is the action within the team's influence?

☐ Is the action small enough to begin and meaningful enough to matter?

Examples of stronger action language

Instead of	Write the visible action
Improve communication	Add a five-minute Strategic Imperatives connection to the weekly team huddle.
Partner earlier	Invite the appropriate physician partner into planning before the team finalizes the recommendation.
Support teamwork	Clarify decision roles and handoffs for the selected cross-functional process.
Encourage innovation	Use a monthly team review to identify, test and assess one improvement idea.

Draft the team action

Planning element	Team response
Action	We will…
Intended result	So that…
Start or cadence	Beginning when, by when or how often?
Who experiences it	Who should notice the difference?

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3. Clarify Ownership and Support

Ownership identifies who is accountable for moving the action forward. Contributors may support the work, but accountability should remain clear.

Planning element	Team response
Accountable owner	Who will coordinate progress, remove ambiguity and report back?
Contributors	Who needs to participate, provide expertise or complete part of the action?
Executive sponsor	Who can reinforce importance, remove barriers or align resources?
Partners affected	Which teams, physicians, functions or stakeholders should be consulted or informed?
Decision authority	Who can approve changes or resolve a trade-off if needed?

Ownership conversation

- "Who is best positioned to own this action?"
- "What does ownership include, and what does it not include?"
- "What support does the owner need from the leader or team?"
- "Where could ownership become unclear or shared too broadly?"
- "How and when will the owner report progress?"

OWNERSHIP LANGUAGE "[Name/role] owns the action. [Contributors] will support by _____. The executive leader will sponsor the work by _____."

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4. Define Success Measures

Success measures help the team determine whether the action is being completed, changing daily work and creating the intended result. Use a balanced set of measures when practical.

Measure type	What it tells the team	Examples to consider
Activity	Whether the agreed action occurred.	Frequency, completion, participation, use of a new routine.
Behavior	Whether people are working differently.	Earlier engagement, clearer handoffs, consistent feedback, visible follow-through.
Experience	Whether stakeholders notice a difference.	Feedback from patients, physicians, team members or internal partners.
Outcome	Whether the action contributes to the intended result.	Quality, service, access, safety, engagement, efficiency, growth or value measures relevant to the action.
Learning	What the team is discovering and adjusting.	Barriers identified, assumptions tested, improvements made after review.

Success measure worksheet

Planning element	Team response
Measure 1	What will the team monitor?
Starting point	What is true today?
Target or evidence	What result, pattern or observable change will indicate progress?
Source	Where will the information come from?
Review cadence	How often will the team look at it?
Measure owner	Who will bring the evidence to the review?

MEASURE WHAT MATTERS Choose measures that help the team learn and act. Do not add measures that create reporting work without improving decisions or follow-through.

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5. Plan Follow-Up and Reinforcement

Follow-up is where the Strategic Imperatives become part of normal work. Use existing leadership and team rhythms whenever possible rather than creating a separate process.

Select the follow-up rhythm

☐ Weekly or biweekly team huddle

☐ Monthly operating or performance review

☐ Project or initiative checkpoint

☐ Physician or partner forum

☐ Leader rounding or one-on-one conversations

☐ Quarterly strategy or talent discussion

Use a short progress conversation

1 **RECONNECT** *"Which Strategic Imperative and intended result does this action support?"*

2 **REVIEW** *"What action was completed, and what evidence do we have?"*

3 **LEARN** *"What is working, what is getting in the way and what have we learned?"*

4 **ADJUST** *"What needs to change in the action, support, measure or timing?"*

5 **RECOMMIT** *"What is the next visible step, who owns it and when will we review it?"*

Follow-up plan

Planning element	Team response
First review	Date or meeting cadence
Ongoing forum	Where will progress be discussed?
Progress reporter	Who will bring the update and evidence?
Escalation point	What issue should be elevated, and to whom?
Recognition	How will progress and contributions be acknowledged?
Close or sustain	How will the action be embedded, expanded or concluded?

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6. Team Action Plan

Complete one action plan for each priority commitment. Keep the plan visible and revisit it in the selected follow-up rhythm.

Planning element	Team response
Strategic Imperative	Which imperative does this action make visible?
Opportunity	What team opportunity or gap are we addressing?
Action	We will…
Intended result	So that…
Accountable owner	Name or role
Contributors	Names, roles or partner groups
Start / target / cadence	When will the action begin, occur or be completed?
Success measures	Activity, behavior, experience, outcome or learning evidence
Starting point	What is true today?
Follow-up forum	Where and how often will progress be reviewed?
Next review	Specific date or agreed cadence
Support needed	Barrier removal, resources, decisions or sponsorship
Status / learning	What is progressing, changing or being learned?

Team commitment

COMPLETE TOGETHER "For our team, this Strategic Imperative means we will _____ so that _____. [Owner] will lead the action, and we will review progress through _____."

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7. Team Action Register

Use this register to maintain a concise view of the team's active Strategic Imperatives commitments.

Imperative	Visible action	Owner	Target / cadence	Success measure	Status	Next review	Support / follow-up

Status guide

NOT STARTED | **IN PROGRESS** | **AT RISK** | **EMBEDDED / COMPLETE**

Follow-up questions

- "What progress is visible?"
- "What evidence supports the status?"
- "What barrier or decision needs attention?"
- "What adjustment will strengthen the action?"
- "What is the next step, owner and review point?"

MAKE ACCOUNTABILITY VISIBLE End every review with a named next step, accountable owner and follow-up point.

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8. Final Team Check

Before completing the action-planning conversation, confirm that the team can answer each question clearly.

☐ Which Strategic Imperative does the action support?

☐ What specific action will become visible in daily work?

☐ Who is accountable, and who will contribute?

☐ What evidence will show implementation, behavioral change or impact?

☐ What support, decision or barrier removal is needed?

☐ When and where will progress be reviewed?

☐ How will the team learn, adjust and recognize progress?

LEADERSHIP COMMITMENT Make the connection clear. Model the expectations. Sponsor the action. Reinforce follow-through.

Brief leader close

"Our action plan is how we will make the Strategic Imperatives visible in the work. We have identified what we will do, who owns it, how we will know it is making a difference and when we will review progress. Our follow-through will determine the impact."

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